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RESOLUTION MEPC.380(80) (adopted on 7 July 2023)

DESIGNATION OF THE NORTH-WESTERN MEDITERRANEAN SEA AS A PARTICULARLY SENSITIVE SEA AREAMEPC 80/17/Add.1

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.2 adoption on 15 July 2011 of a PSSA for the Strait of Bonifacio by resolution MEPC.204(62) which refers to protective measures previously adopted by resolution A.766(18) on 4 November 1993; and

.3 adoption on 16 December 2022 of the Mediterranean Sea Emission Control Area for Sulphur Oxides and Particulate Matter by resolution MEPC.361(79).

3.40 Measures have also been taken for the protection of cetaceans including

.1 International Pelagos Sanctuary - the Pelagos Agreement (November 1999) for the protection of marine mammals within the Pelagos Sanctuary entered into force on 21 February 2002, after ratification by the three concerned countries (France, Italy, Monaco). The Sanctuary covers a total are a

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for the protection of marine mammals within the Pelagos Sanctuary entered into force on 21 February 2002, after ratification by the three concerned countries (France, Italy, Monaco). The Sanctuary covers a total are a of 87,500 km². The objective of the agreement is to maintain a favourable conservation status for marine mammal populations within the Sanctuary, and to this end, to monitor cetacean populations, to reinforce the application of existing legislation on certain fishing activities, to reduce pollution, to regulate tourist observation of cetaceans and to improve the dissemination of information to the public. Since November 2002, the Pelagos Sanctuary has also been recognized by the Barcelona Convention Contracting Parties as a specially protected area of Mediterranean importance (SPAMI); and

.2 The MPA cetacean migration corridor in the Mediterranean (Spain) - The Spanish government has designated a 46,385 km² corridor between Valencia, Catalonia and the Balearic Islands as a Marine Protected Area, to protect cetaceans present and migrating in the area. The Barcelona Convention, allowing the area to be designated as a SPAMI, validated this in

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Valencia, Catalonia and the Balearic Islands as a Marine Protected Area, to protect cetaceans present and migrating in the area. The Barcelona Convention, allowing the area to be designated as a SPAMI, validated this in December 2019.

3.41 In addition a large number of measures have been taken for the wider protection of environments at the national level, these are listed in document MEPC 79/10.

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ANNEX 4

ASSOCIATED PROTECTIVE MEASURE FOR THE NORTH-WESTERN MEDITERRANEAN SEA PARTICULARLY SENSITIVE SEA AREA (NW MED PSSA)

Associated Protective Measures (APMs)

The associated protective measures (APMs) recommendatory in nature as identified below are deemed to be applied by any commercial ships and pleasure yachts from 300 gross tonnage and upwards; the APMs would not apply to any warship and other governmental ships operated for non-commercial purposes.

1 Mariners should navigate with particular caution within the NW Med PSSA, in areas

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tonnage and upwards; the APMs would not apply to any warship and other governmental ships operated for non-commercial purposes.

1 Mariners should navigate with particular caution within the NW Med PSSA, in areas

where large and medium cetaceans are detected or reported, and reduce their speed to between 10 and 13 knots as voluntary speed reduction (VSR). However, a safe speed should be kept, so that proper and effective action could be taken to avoid collision and any possible negative impacts on ship's manoeuvrability.

2 Mariners should keep an appropriate safety distance or speed reduction measure from any large and medium cetaceans observed or detected in close quarter situation. The safety distance or speed reduction measure should be adapted to the actual navigation circumstances and conditions of the ship.

3 Mariners should broadcast on VHF or other available means on scene, the position of medium and large cetaceans observed or detected within the designated PSSA and transmit the information and the position to a designated coastal Authority or Authorities.

4 Mariners should report any collision with cetaceans to a designated coastal Authority

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transmit the information and the position to a designated coastal Authority or Authorities.

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